

STEADY PRESS

Headache & Migraine Log

Track every attack — timing, triggers, aura, medication and what finally stopped it — in a format neurologists recognise.

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FORMAT	PAGES	USE
US Letter	10	Print as many copies as you need

How to use this journal

THE ROUTINE

- Rate pain on the same 0–10 scale every time. The absolute number matters far less than the direction it moves over weeks.

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

NO PAIN WORST IMAGINABLE

1 Noticeable, easy to ignore 3 Annoying, does not stop you 5 Hard to concentrate through 7 Limits what you can do

9 Unable to function

This is a record-keeping tool, not medical advice. Bring it to a professional rather than using it to self-diagnose.

Attack log

One per headache. Print plenty.

DATE	STARTED	ENDED	TOTAL HOURS

PEAK INTENSITY

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
MILD										WORST

LOCATION

☐ One side — left	☐ One side — right	☐ Both sides
☐ Behind the eye	☐ Forehead / temples	☐ Base of skull
☐ Top of head	☐ Whole head	☐ Moved during attack

CHARACTER & SYMPTOMS

☐ Throbbing / pulsing	☐ Pressing / tight band	☐ Stabbing
☐ Worse with movement	☐ Nausea	☐ Vomiting
☐ Light sensitivity	☐ Sound sensitivity	☐ Smell sensitivity
☐ Visual aura	☐ Tingling or numbness	☐ Speech difficulty

MEDICATION TAKEN

TIME	WHAT	DOSE	RELIEF (0-10)	HOW LONG UNTIL RELIEF

WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN THE 24 HOURS BEFORE

WARNING SIGNS

Prodrome & aura

Many people have reliable warning signs hours before the pain. Finding yours buys you treatment time.

HOURS BEFORE AN ATTACK I OFTEN NOTICE

- ☐ Yawning repeatedly
- ☐ Unusual thirst
- ☐ Irritability or low mood
- ☐ Difficulty finding words
- ☐ Light seems too bright
- ☐ Difficulty concentrating
- ☐ Food cravings
- ☐ Neck stiffness
- ☐ Unusual energy or elation
- ☐ Blurred vision
- ☐ Frequent urination
- ☐ Sensitivity to smells

WARNING-SIGN LOG

DATE	SIGN NOTICED	HOURS BEFORE PAIN	DID EARLY TREATMENT HELP?

Trigger tracker

COMMON TRIGGERS TO TEST

- ☐ Missed or late meal
- ☐ Alcohol — red wine
- ☐ Chocolate
- ☐ Stress, or the let-down after
- ☐ Strong smells
- ☐ Poor or excess sleep
- ☐ Caffeine, or withdrawal
- ☐ Bright or flickering light
- ☐ Weather change
- ☐ Neck or jaw tension
- ☐ Dehydration
- ☐ Aged cheese
- ☐ Screen time
- ☐ Hormonal cycle
- ☐ Exercise

SUSPECTED TRIGGER LOG

DATE	EXPOSURE	HOURS TO ONSET	SEVERITY	CONFIRMED?

OVERVIEW

Monthly headache calendar

Shade every day you had any head pain at all, including the mild ones you would normally forget.

MONTH

YEAR

DAY OF MONTH

M	T	W	T	F	S	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

KEY

☐ Mild ☒ Moderate ☐ Severe ☐ Rescue medication taken ☐ Aura

MONTH TOTALS

HEADACHE DAYS	SEVERE DAYS	RESCUE DOSES	DAYS OFF WORK
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More than ten rescue doses in a month is worth raising with your doctor — overuse can itself cause headaches.

EVERY SUNDAY

Weekly review

Ten minutes looking back is where the pattern actually shows up.

WEEK OF

BEST DAY

WORST DAY

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

DAY	AVG PAIN	SLEEP	NOTABLE
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WHAT MADE IT BETTER

WHAT MADE IT WORSE

ONE THING TO CHANGE NEXT WEEK

APPOINTMENT

Doctor visit prep

Fill this in the day before. Most appointments are short — walking in with this changes what you get out of it.

DATE OF VISIT	SEEING

IN ONE SENTENCE, WHAT IS THE PROBLEM?

THE FACTS

QUESTION	YOUR ANSWER

HAVE YOU ALREADY TRIED

☐ Rest	☐ Heat	☐ Ice
☐ Stretching	☐ Painkillers	☐ Physio
☐ Massage	☐ New pillow	☐ Desk changes

QUESTIONS I WANT ANSWERED

WHAT WAS DECIDED

Before you start

These pages are a personal record-keeping tool. They are not a medical device, they do not diagnose anything, and nothing here is medical advice.

Tracking is useful because it turns vague memory into specifics you can hand to a professional: when it started, what makes it worse, what you already tried. It is not a substitute for seeing one.

See a qualified healthcare professional about any new, severe, or worsening symptom. Seek urgent care for chest pain, numbness or weakness in a limb, loss of bladder or bowel control, severe headache of sudden onset, pain following an accident, fever with neck stiffness, or any symptom that frightens you.

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